

type **'lilo'** if your boot loader is lilo, or **'grub-install'** if the boot loader used is grub, and press [Enter].

Dial-up hackers

Q. I'm worried about my dial-up Internet connection. What happens if someone knows my username, and tries to guess my password over and over again? Will this lock my password? If so, how do I prevent this?

Binod

A When someone tries to hack your password using the brute force technique—trying each possible combination—the account is suspended for a preset time period. After 10 or 15 minutes, you should be able to use your account again.

Some ISPs, such as VSNL, offer a feature where you can lock your account usage from a specific phone number. This is good, because unless the hacker is sitting in your house, or hacking your phone line, he or she cannot access your account.

Blue screen advertisements

Q. I have a dual-boot PC running Windows Me and Windows XP. Recently, I started getting an error message during bootup. I took a screenshot of the error. What is the problem?

Agk Nair

A The application specified in the error message—CD_LOAD.EXE—has been installed by Cydoor's adware application. It downloads advertisements to your computer as soon as you go online. Search for the application, and delete it. Also, load an anti-spyware application to keep your computer from facing this problem again.



Use anti-spyware to protect your PC from nasty errors such as this one by Cydoor adware

Choosy CD-ROM

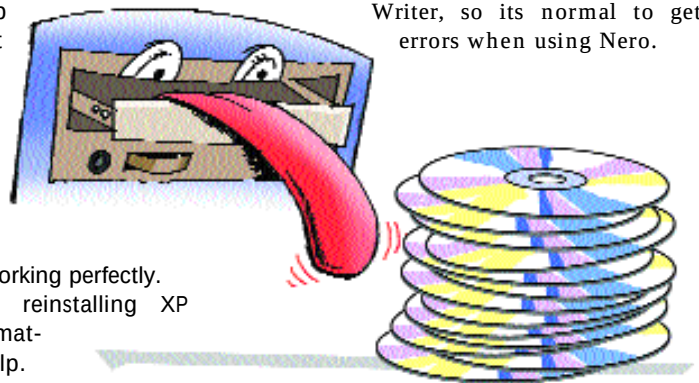
Q. I have a Compaq Presario computer with Windows XP Home Edition and a 48x CD-ROM drive. The problem is that the CD-ROM drive only reads the CDs that came with the computer—the OS CD, drivers CD, etc. It completely ignores other CDs, even when there's a CD in the drive, it asks to insert one.

I have tried about eight CDs, all unscratched. I also installed Nero Burning ROM 5 and Image

Drive. The help and support says that there is a SCSI problem, while properties in device manager reports the device to be working perfectly.

I've tried reinstalling XP without formatting. Please help.

Siddharth



A Most packaged CDs are pressed, not burnt. These pressed CDs are made so that they work on all CD drives. Certain CD-Rs may not be compatible with your drive. Check your drive by attempting to use CD-Rs from other manufacturers. If this fails, send your drive to a service center, as the problem is a faulty lens.

Nero is CD-writing software, and you have a CD-ROM drive not a CD-Writer, so its normal to get errors when using Nero.

I can't write

Q. My Sony CD-RW CRX175A1 24x/10x/40x shows the 'Power calibration' error when writing, and stops. What is the problem? Do I have to change the CD-RW?

Ravi S

A Power Calibration is controlled by the recorder. Before any write operation, all recorders must do a 15-step power test to determine the optimum power for writing to the CD—this is called Optimum Power Calibration (OPC). During a write, it continues to do this

test to get the best write throughout the whole CD—this is called Running Optimum Power Calibration (ROPC). This whole process is controlled by the recorder, but is initiated by programs such as Nero. There is an area on the inner part of the CD for the test and test data information to be stored. You can use this area up to 999 times.

So, when you receive the 'Power Calibration Error' or 'Power Calibration Area full' error message, it's because of poor media, poor power, or a defective recorder. Most often, it's due to bad media, so try using better CD-Rs.

Break the partition

Q. I have a 20 GB Seagate hard drive, which has two partitions of 10 GB each. Since I wanted one single partition of 20 GB, I went through fdisk and deleted the primary and the extended partition. However, the partitions still exist. I also tried deleting them with the help of the disk manager provided by Seagate, but they are stubborn. What should I do?

Y S Samyal

A Yes, parting with partitions can be very frustrating. To delete the partition, first go to the BIOS, select the hard disk